



# God Gives - 09.13.26

## Pastor Mark Schilling

### **Ecclesiastes 2:12-26(NIV)**

Then I turned my thoughts to consider wisdom,  
and also madness and folly.

What more can the king's successor do  
than what has already been done?

13 I saw that wisdom is better than folly,  
just as light is better than darkness.

14 The wise have eyes in their heads,  
while the fool walks in the darkness;

but I came to realize  
that the same fate overtakes them both.

15 Then I said to myself,  
"The fate of the fool will overtake me also.

What then do I gain by being wise?"

I said to myself,  
"This too is meaningless."

16 For the wise, like the fool, will not be long remembered;  
the days have already come when both have been forgotten.  
Like the fool, the wise too must die!

17 So I hated life, because the work that is done under the sun was grievous to me. All of it is meaningless, a chasing after the wind. 18 I hated all the things I had toiled for under the sun, because I must leave them to the one who comes after me. 19 And who knows whether that person will be wise or foolish? Yet they will have control over all the fruit of my toil into which I have poured my effort and skill under the sun. This too is meaningless. 20 So my heart began to despair over all my toilsome labor under the sun. 21 For a person may labor with wisdom, knowledge and skill, and then they must leave all they own to another who has not toiled for it. This too is meaningless and a great misfortune. 22 What do people get for all the toil and anxious striving with which they labor under the sun? 23 All their days their work is grief and pain; even at night their minds do not rest. This too is meaningless. 24 A person can do nothing better than to eat and drink and find satisfaction in their own toil. This too, I see, is from the hand of God, 25 for without him, who can eat or find enjoyment? 26 To the person who pleases him, God gives wisdom, knowledge and happiness, but to the sinner he gives the task of gathering and storing up wealth to hand it over to the one who pleases God. This too is meaningless, a chasing after the wind.

## **1. Work under the sun is futility**

### **Ecclesiastes 2:17-19**

So I hated life, because the work that is done under the sun was grievous to me. All of it is meaningless, a chasing after the wind. 18 I hated all the things I had toiled for under the sun, because I must leave them to the one who comes after me. 19 And who knows whether that person will be wise or foolish? Yet they will have control over all the fruit of my toil into which I have poured my effort and skill under the sun. This too is meaningless.

## **2. Futility is a gateway to TRUE faith.**

### **Ecclesiastes 2:20-26**

So my heart began to despair over all my toilsome labor under the sun. 21 For a person may labor with wisdom, knowledge and skill, and then they must leave all they own to another who has not toiled for it. This too is meaningless and a great misfortune. 22 What do people get for all the toil and anxious striving with which they labor under the sun? 23 All their days their work is grief and pain; even at night their minds do not rest. This too is meaningless. 24 A person can do nothing better than to eat and drink and find satisfaction in their own toil. This too, I see, is from the hand of God, 25 for without him, who can eat or find enjoyment? 26 To the person who pleases him, God gives wisdom, knowledge and happiness, but to the sinner he gives the task of gathering and storing up wealth to hand it over to the one who pleases God. This too is meaningless, a chasing after the wind.

3. We must live life in view of death

**Are we living under the SUN  
or under the SON?**

**Our life is not defined by the  
GREATEST thing we have ever done**

**Our life is not defined by the  
WORST thing you have ever done.**

**Our life is defined by what  
Christ has done.**

### **Colossians 3:2-4(NIV)**

Set your minds on things above, not on earthly things. 3 For you died, and *your life is now* hidden with Christ in God. 4 When Christ, who is your life, appears, then you also will appear with him in glory.

### **Colossians 3:1-4 (The Message)**

So if you're serious about living this new resurrection life with Christ, act like it. Pursue the things over which Christ presides. Don't shuffle along, eyes to the ground, absorbed with the things right in front of you. Look up, and be alert to what is going on around Christ—that's where the action is. See things from his perspective. 3-4 Your old life is dead. Your new life, which is *your real life*—even though invisible to spectators—is with Christ in God. *He is your life.* When Christ (your real life, remember) shows up again on this earth, you'll show up, too—the real you, the glorious you. Meanwhile, be content with obscurity, like Christ. Christ gives life that death cannot take away

## **4. A secure soul can enjoy the good gifts of God rightly.**

### **Ecclesiastes 2:24–26**

A person can do nothing better than to eat and drink and find satisfaction in their own toil. This too, I see, is from the hand of God, 25 for without him, who can eat or find enjoyment? 26 To the person who pleases him, God gives wisdom, knowledge and happiness...

**Solomon has been saying:**

- I built.**
- I acquired.**
- I accumulated.**
- I achieved.**
- I worked.**

**But now: God gives**